

The Noble Great Breath, King of Vidyā-Mantras

Āryamahāprāṇanāmaavidyārāja · Toh 773 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རག་སྒྲུ་ཀུན་པ་དྲུག་ཆེ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ།

The Noble Great Breath, King of Vidyā-Mantras (Āryamahāprāṇanāmaavidyārāja in Sanskrit, 'phags pa rig sngags kyi rgyal po dbugs chen po zhes bya ba in Tibetan) is a short Buddhist protective text, a dhāraṇī, that takes the form of a discourse spoken to the Buddha. It opens with a fearsome lord of beings, the ruler of the fourth continent, named Tawny Fang, who confesses to the Blessed One that his hungry breath spreads sickness and drains the vitality of humans and non-humans alike. The text thus concerns the dangerous, disease-bringing forces that afflict living beings and the mantric means of pacifying them. It is Toh 773 in the Kangyur, found among the tantra section, where texts of this protective and ritual kind are gathered.

The Noble Great Breath, King of Vidyā-Mantras.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the great lord of beings, ruler of the fourth continent, whose name was Tawny Fang, who has bared and gnashing tusks, addressed the Blessed One with these words.

Blessed One, I am the lord of all beings. In the world-system of the fourth continent, I harm all the beings who dwell there. I strike them, I bind them, I hurl them from this world-system into another world-system, and I cut off their limbs and their lesser limbs.

Blessed One, whenever I become hungry, I breathe out, and with that breath I fill the entire world-system of the fourth continent. Blessed One, I seize the vitality and radiance of humans and non-humans alike. The moment the Great Breath touches sentient beings, diseases of every kind and the sicknesses of weakness arise.

Blessed One, wherever this vidyā-mantra called the Great Breath, King of Vidyā-Mantras, is practiced, my breath will not take hold, and the beings will not be harmed. Whatever son or daughter of good family pays homage to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and then wears it, tied upon the head or about the neck, in that place illnesses arising from wind, from bile, from phlegm, and from their combination will not occur. From this day forward, in the presence of the Tathāgata, I solemnly make this pledge.

Tadyathā: ḍara ḍara, ḍaḍara, ḍaḍara, thara thara, thathara, mara mara, mamara, mamara, hudhuhu, hahaha, sara sara sara, cucucu, bububu, kili kili kili, sarva bhūta adhipate, pradradra, brabrabra, khukhukhu, krakrakra, yasa yasa yasa, pāṇḍare, pāṇḍare, pāṇḍare, hulu hulu hulu, huhuhu. Protect me, protect me. Cili cili cili, mili mili mili, kṣo kṣo kṣo, gauri gauri gauri. May all my illnesses be completely pacified, svāhā. Mātā śvāsāya svāhā. Mahā bhūta adhipataye svāhā. Gauriye svāhā. Ugrāya svāhā. May I be well and happy. Daṃṣṭrī karāla piṅgala ājñāvayati svāhā.

The Noble Great Breath, King of Vidyā-Mantras, is complete.

It was translated and finalized by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé dé.

Translator's Notes

- The name Tawny Fang renders the Tibetan "mche ba gtsigs pa ser skya," which seems to be an epithet-name for a lord of the fourth continent; the Sanskrit original is not reconstructed here. The mantra is transliterated rather than translated, as is customary, and the vocalization follows the Sanskrit forms implied by the Tibetan transcription. Several syllables are probably corrupt or irregular, and the ending "daṃṣṭrī karāla piṅgala ājñāvayati" is given as it appears. The Tibetan "gzi byin" is rendered "vitality and radiance." The Tibetan "bro nad" is rendered "sicknesses of weakness," a literal reading of a term sometimes understood as diseases that deprive one of taste or vigor.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.